

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

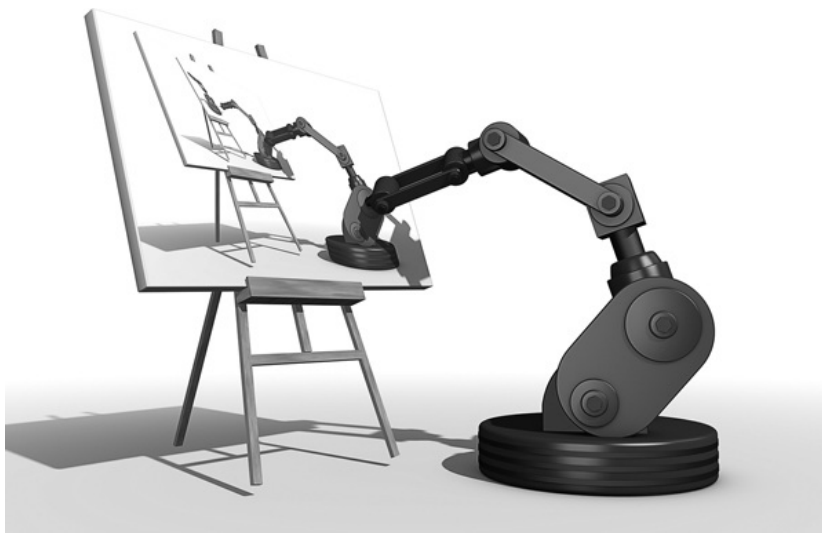
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Let's Start!

Is borrowing ideas a no-no in the workplace?



Learning Outcome

Discuss factual and abstract information about common everyday or job related topics in both work and social contexts appropriate for the interlocutor.

Ask your partner:

- What do you think about copying someone else's work and using it as your own?
- Is it acceptable? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can express strong disapproval.
- I can talk about reactions and behavior in different situations related to work issues.
- I can talk about expectations related to work issues.





Let's Explore!

Adam reads an article on business **ethics***.

* "*Ethics*" are a system of moral principles that show you are a good (upstanding or ethical) individual.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Being pressured to meet a deadline may cause some employees to borrow and present another person's thoughts or ideas as their own. It is seen as a quick and easy way to be done with their work. This work "borrowing" is also known as plagiarism. You may wonder, "How do people do such things?" It shouldn't be allowed and it isn't, but it happens more often than you think.

You usually think of plagiarism as writers' stories having been stolen by other writers. However, it goes beyond this. Taking reports, ad campaigns, articles or other written texts and using them without the creator being credited counts as plagiarism.

You may think that using a few lines written by someone else is acceptable, or you may say "What a rotten thing to do!" The act of stealing work from another writer, whether it is two sentences or an entire essay, has ethical and legal implications.

To be caught plagiarizing copyrighted material is an offence that has consequences, such as heavy fines. It's not always just text either. Let's take a software program for example. A detailed list of code is included in every program. You may not think much of that, but it may have taken years for a computer program to be perfected. Using anything that is part of a proprietary software being protected by copyright laws is also against the law.

"What about art?" you may ask. Being inspired and influenced by art that you admire, you may accidentally steal an artist's idea. For a new design to be created, a lot of inspiration is required. If you mimic a design that is close to an original work, you may have unknowingly crossed the divide between influenced and copycat.





Let's Practice!

The article on business ethics talks about plagiarism.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Circle the correct option to complete the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. To be _____ (**catch, caught, cot**) plagiarizing copyrighted material is an offence.
2. You usually think of plagiarism as writers' stories _____ (**having stolen, being stole, having been stolen**) by other writers.
3. Using anything that is part of a propriety software _____ (**is being protect, protecting, being protected**) by copyright laws is also against the law.
4. _____ (**Being inspire, Being inspired, Be inspired**) by art that you admire, you may accidentally steal an artist's idea.
5. For a new design _____, (**to be created, to be create, to being created**) a lot of inspiration is required.



Let's Practice!

Adam talks about plagiarism*. Don't be a copycat**!

*Look closely at how the word "*plagiarism*" is spelled. We do not always hear every letter when it is spoken.

**A "*copycat*" is a person who copies the work of another person.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Cross out the incorrect word. Write each sentence correctly. Read the correct sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. "Borrowing" another person's work is also known as plagiarism.

2. Using reports, add campaigns, brochure content or memos written by others counts.

3. You need to give the credit for to the original athor or creator.

4. Using an image that is under a proper software can lead to fines.

5. Many documents and images have been copywright for this reason.

6. If you use a design that closely mimics the original, you may have stepped over the line from influences to copy cat.





Extension Activity

Share your opinion about an important work related matter.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- What's your opinion about plagiarism? Write down your thoughts about it.
- Go to the library or on the Internet.
- Do some research. Find evidence from articles that support your opinion.
- Use your research to write a short response paper (16-20 sentences) about your views on plagiarism.
- Proofread your response.
- Share it with a partner. Ask for their opinion.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I form an opinion about an issue related to work.

☐
☐

I identify evidence that helps support my opinion.

☐
☐

I write about issues related to work.

☐
☐


Target Words

- plagiarism** (noun): using another person's words, ideas, or work and pretending it is your own
e.g. This work "borrowing" is also known as plagiarism.
- ad campaign** (noun): a series of advertisements intended to achieve a particular result relating to business
e.g. Their idea for the ad campaign was stolen by the competition.
- creator** (noun): someone who made a particular thing
e.g. They are the creators of this program.
- credit** (noun): praise that you give to someone for something they have done
e.g. The creators of the program were not given any credit.
- to count** (verb): to be considered in a particular way
e.g. Not giving the creator credit counts as plagiarism.
- copyrighted** (adjective): protected by copyright
e.g. Being caught plagiarizing copyrighted work can lead to fines.
- proprietary** (adjective): relating to who owns something
e.g. Using an image to promote your program or anything that is part of a proprietary software which is being protected by copyright laws is also against the law.
- to mimic** (verb): to copy the way someone does something
e.g. If you mimic a design that is close to an original work, you may have unknowingly crossed the line.
- influenced** (adjective): to be affected by someone or something
e.g. Being inspired and influenced by art that you admire, you may accidentally steal an artist's idea.





Learning Points

Passive Infinitives and Gerunds

You use the passive infinitive or -ing form in some constructions using the passive voice. You use the passive voice when you want to focus on the receiver of the action, rather than the doer (agent).

If the subject is not the agent, you use a passive infinitive:

For example:

*The systems are **to be checked** as soon as possible.*

You use passive -ing forms after verbs that are normally followed by a gerund (love, recall etc.)

For example:

*I **love being given** chocolates!*

You can use the passive -ing form with the meaning of 'because'.

For example:

***Having been bitten** by a dog, I have no love of them.*

Examples:

- **Being pressured** to meet a deadline may cause some employees to borrow and present another person's thoughts or ideas as their own.
- You usually think of plagiarism as writers' stories **having been stolen** by other writers.
- **To be caught** plagiarizing copyrighted material is an offence.

Expressing Strong Disapproval

In a work environment there may come a time when you do not agree with or approve of a decision that somebody made. There are tactful ways to express your disapproval.

Look at the chart below. It contains a list of phrases or expressions you can use. It ranks them from weak to stronger in meaning:





Learning Points

Phrase	Meaning
I don't think much of that.	The speaker disapproves, but is only slightly bothered by the action. They only mildly agree with others who feel far more strongly that they do.
I'm utterly appalled/disgusted.	The speaker feels more strongly about an action. These phrases are said immediately after they find out about the action.
I'm dead against that.	The speaker is talking about an action that they do not approve of in general.
It shouldn't be allowed!	The speaker is stating that they would like people legally stopped from doing an action. They feel the action is wrong. They are also inferring that the action, at the present time, is legal.
What a rotten/mean thing to do.	The speaker has a very strong negative reaction to an action. This is something that they have only just heard about. The speaker sympathizes with the victim to whom the action was done.
Who do they think they are? How do people do such things?	The speaker feels very strongly that an action was wrong. They disapprove of both the action and those who did it.

Examples:

- You may wonder, **"How do people do such things?" It shouldn't be allowed** and it isn't.
- **You may not think much of that** but it may have taken a programmer years to perfect.
- You might think, **"What a rotten thing to do!"**

